Alder

Atlanta / Restaurant build-out

A dining room that feels settled from the first service. A kitchen planned for the pace behind it.

Our starting point is the meeting of those two ambitions: protect the room’s character while resolving equipment, building services, and the sequence of work early.

Before we establish an opening date, we recommend confirming the existing utilities and the kitchen exhaust route.

Working construction budget
$1.50m, including $150k owner contingency

Illustrative sequence
24 weeks from preconstruction authorization; opening date unconfirmed

Status
Illustrative proposal / Not an estimate

Prepared by
Author to be confirmed

01 PROJECT & APPROACH

A room that works as well as it feels.

Alder is imagined as a neighborhood restaurant with the kitchen in view and the dining room at ease. We would begin where those experiences meet: equipment layout, service routes, sound, and the junctions between materials.

3,200 sq ft / 80 / Leased second-generation restaurant space / Open to view from the dining room / Evening dinner program. Illustrative inputs for this study.

THREE PRIORITIES

1. **Protect the character of the room.**
   Finishes, light, and sound are decided as a whole, and the junctions guests see are resolved before they are built.
2. **Resolve the working requirements of the kitchen.**
   Equipment, utilities, ventilation, and service routes are coordinated before pricing, not after installation begins.
3. **Make cost and sequence legible before committing to the build.**
   Every amount carries its basis and every date its starting condition, so authorization is an informed step.

WHAT WE WOULD CONFIRM FIRST

Existing utility capacity →

Electrical, gas, and water capacity for an expanded kitchen has not been verified.

Kitchen exhaust route →

A compliant path from hood to roof or façade has not been confirmed with the landlord.

HOW WE WOULD WORK

We build with attention to the whole project and the details that carry it. Our role is to make the design buildable, coordinate the work, and keep decisions clear from the first review through turnover.

Review constructability with the architect

Reconcile trade scope against the drawings

Coordinate procurement and site work

Prepare inspections and handover

Proposed statement / for company approval

BASIS

Fictional scenario; no site survey or client drawings received.

Basis of this proposal →

BASIS OF THIS PROPOSAL / 01 PROJECT & APPROACH

Basis of this proposal

Fictional scenario; no site survey or client drawings received.

CATEGORY	Client inputs
ITEM	Founder brief: 80 seats, visible kitchen, evening service
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Illustrative

CATEGORY	Client inputs
ITEM	Premises: 3,200 sq ft leased second-generation space
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Illustrative

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Architect’s drawing set
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Existing building and MEP drawings from landlord
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Kitchen equipment schedule and cut sheets
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Site observations
ITEM	Walk-through of the premises
DATED	—
STATUS	Not made

CATEGORY	Site observations
ITEM	Existing services and exhaust route survey
DATED	—
STATUS	Proposed

CATEGORY	Assumptions
ITEM	No structural expansion of the premises
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Assumed

CATEGORY	Assumptions
ITEM	Existing services reused where capacity permits
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Unverified

CATEGORY	Outstanding
ITEM	Lease exhibit and landlord work letter
DATED	—
STATUS	Requested on appointment

CATEGORY	Outstanding
ITEM	Hazardous-material survey, if the landlord holds one
DATED	—
STATUS	Requested on appointment

Issue 01 / 14 October 2026. Items not yet received are release dependencies for a priced proposal.

02 RELEVANT WORK

Where the kitchen meets the room.

This reference will focus on the work Freeman can document: the assignment, the people involved, and the decisions made in the field.

For Alder, the question is how that experience informs the coordination of a guest-facing room and a working kitchen.

Internal study. Not ready for client issue. Each historical field below must be filled from a record, or the topic removed.

Verification register →

REFERENCE / FREEMAN ROLE PENDING VERIFICATION

Little Rey / Rocket Farm Restaurants

Plate 1 / Finished photograph of the kitchen line

Plate 2 / Equipment layout or utility rough-in record

Equipment coordination

FOR ALDER

We would confirm who purchases, installs, and starts each piece of equipment, then overlay the equipment schedule on the utility rough-in before pricing.

See the equipment boundary decision, the kitchen equipment boundary, Week 21, equipment readiness

WHAT THE RECORD WILL SHOW

Intent
The operational requirement for the kitchen equipment and its utilities.

Condition
A dated coordination record — for example a rough-in conflict or a revised equipment schedule.

Freeman’s contribution
Freeman’s exact coordination role, distinguished from the equipment supplier’s and the architect’s.

Evidence
A field record or approved drawing detail with permission to show it.

Each historical statement will be drawn from a dated record before this reference is issued.

RELEVANT WORK / A MATERIAL JUNCTION

Plate 1 / Finished photograph of the junction in use

Plate 2 / Approved detail or field photograph of the same junction

A material junction

FOR ALDER

Before ordering millwork, we would mock up the junction where the dining room’s finishes meet the open kitchen’s cleanable surfaces and review it with the architect.

See Millwork allowance, Architectural build-out, Long-lead procurement, weeks 5–16

WHAT THE RECORD WILL SHOW

Intent
The design requirement for a guest-facing junction, from the architect’s drawings.

Condition
What the team encountered, with a dated field report or RFI.

Freeman’s contribution
The action Freeman or a named team member took, credited separately from the architect and other builders.

Evidence
An attributable photograph or approved detail, with photographer, date, and permission.

RELEVANT WORK / A FIELD DECISION

Plate 1 / Photograph of the completed condition

Plate 2 / Field record of the decision, dated

A field decision

FOR ALDER

We would investigate the existing services and the exhaust route before the construction baseline, so that a concealed condition becomes a planned decision rather than a field surprise.

See the services investigation decision, the exhaust route condition, Week 8, construction start gate

WHAT THE RECORD WILL SHOW

Intent
What the drawings required at the point the decision was made.

Condition
The concealed or unexpected condition, with a dated field record.

Freeman’s contribution
Who proposed the response, who approved it, and how cost and time were reported.

Evidence
A field photograph or written record, attributed and permitted.

VERIFICATION REGISTER / 02 RELEVANT WORK

Verification register

Little Rey / Rocket Farm Restaurants. Every field must be resolved from a record before this reference is issued to a client. If only one contribution can be substantiated, one account is published. If none can, the reference is withdrawn.

BEFORE CLIENT ISSUE

Location	Piedmont or Northside Parkway — unresolved
Dates	Not established
Contracting entity	Not established
Direct client	Not established
Freeman or prior-employer work	Not established
Contracted scope	Not established
Named participants	Not established
Drawing and image permissions	Not requested
Claimed outcome	None claimed

If the work was an individual’s prior experience, it is labeled “Team experience / completed while at [company]”, not presented as a Freeman commission. No Rocket Farm endorsement is implied.

PUBLICLY CONFIRMED CONTEXT

Rocket Farm Restaurants lists Little Rey among its restaurants ↗

www.rocketfarmrestaurants.com/

Little Rey / Piedmont ↗

www.littlerey.com/piedmont

Little Rey / Northside Parkway ↗

www.littlerey.com/northside-parkway

These public sources identify the restaurant and its two Atlanta locations. They do not establish Freeman’s construction role.

EDITORIAL TEMPLATE, NOT APPROVED COPY

At [location], [legal entity or named team member] was responsible for [documented scope] during [dates]. The record below shows [specific action].

03 PEOPLE & SCOPE

A clear line from the decision to the work.

The project manager would be your primary contact. The superintendent would coordinate the daily work. Design changes would return to the architect; cost and time effects would return to you before authorization.

PROPOSED TEAM

Freeman principal

Client relationship, escalation, commercial oversight

Project manager

YOUR PRIMARY CONTACT

Trade scope, procurement, cost reporting, decisions

Superintendent

Daily coordination, sequencing, quality, site safety

Architect / owner-appointed

Design intent, coordinated documents, design responses

Founder / owner

Brief, selections, owner purchases, authorizations

Roles are shown until named people are confirmed for participation and availability.

HOW THE WORK WOULD PROCEED

1 **Verify** existing conditions
2 **Reconcile** drawings and trade proposals
3 **Coordinate** procurement and construction
4 **Test** inspect, and turn over

PROPOSED SCOPE

Selective demolition

Architectural build-out

Mechanical, electrical, plumbing, and fire-protection work, coordinated

Installation coordination for owner-supplied items

Inspections and turnover

All proposed scope, pending survey and documents.

WHERE RESPONSIBILITIES MEET

Kitchen equipment. The owner purchases; the supplier installs and starts up; Freeman coordinates access and priced utility connections.

Responsibility boundaries →

RESPONSIBILITY BOUNDARIES / 03 PEOPLE & SCOPE

Responsibility boundaries

Illustrative allocations to test the format. These are not standard Freeman contractual terms; every limit is confirmed before pricing.

Kitchen equipment

WORKED EXAMPLE

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Coordinates delivery, access, and set-in sequence; provides priced utility connections to agreed points
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner purchases; equipment supplier installs and starts up
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Exact connection points for each item; who provides final hook-up and startup testing Equipment boundary decision

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Exhaust hood and duct

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Duct route, roof or façade penetration, fire-rated enclosure
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Hood supplied with equipment package
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Whether the hood is in the owner’s package; landlord approval of the route Services investigation decision

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Walk-in cooler

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Slab preparation, power, and drain
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Supplier provides box and refrigeration
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Remote condenser location Equipment boundary decision

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Low-voltage, POS, audio

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Conduit, back boxes, and pull strings
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner’s vendors cable, install, and program
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Device locations not yet set

Loose furniture

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Receipt and placement if requested
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner purchases and installs
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Banquette: built-in millwork or loose furniture Millwork allowance

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Permits and utility fees

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Building permit application and inspection coordination
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner pays statutory permit and utility connection charges
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Health department plan review submission

Landlord work

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Coordination with landlord’s contractors
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Landlord work letter items
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Work letter not received

04 SCHEDULE

24 illustrative weeks from authorization to handover.

Opening follows owner training, operational readiness, and required approvals. No opening date is committed.

The opening depends on decisions made before the site gets busy. We would establish the construction start after the permit, site access, and coordinated documents are ready. Equipment selections and release dates would be tracked against the work they enable.

Illustrative sequencing assumptions, not permitting or procurement predictions. A delay at the start gate requires a revised schedule; downstream dates are not assumed to hold.

Existing conditions and preconstruction 1–4
Utilities, exhaust route, brief confirmed
Weeks 1–4 / runs alongside design coordination and permitting



Design coordination and permitting 3–8
Design and permit readiness before site work
Weeks 3–8 / runs alongside existing conditions and preconstruction; long-lead procurement



Long-lead procurement 5–16
Approved selections and release authority
Weeks 5–16 / runs alongside design coordination and permitting; demolition and rough-in; finishes and equipment coordination



Demolition and rough-in 9–14
Permit, possession, coordinated documents
Weeks 9–14 / runs alongside long-lead procurement



Finishes and equipment coordination 15–21
Rough-in approvals and equipment arrivals
Weeks 15–21 / runs alongside long-lead procurement



Testing, inspections, punch, handover 22–24
Systems ready; inspections available
Weeks 22–24 / no overlap



Week 8 / Construction start gate

PREREQUISITE
Building permit issued, possession of the premises, coordinated documents

RESPONSIBLE
Project manager, with architect

DEPENDS ON IT
Design coordination and permitting; Demolition and rough-in

AFFECTS
Utility capacity
Exhaust route
Trade construction

THREE CONDITIONS OPEN TODAY

Utility capacity unverified

Project manager

Survey electrical, gas, and water service against the equipment load

Exhaust route unconfirmed

Architect, with project manager

Trace a compliant hood-to-roof route; seek landlord approval

Equipment lead times unquoted

Founder’s equipment supplier

Written lead times once selections are approved

05 BUDGET

A clear basis for the next conversation.

This is a planning exercise. Kitchen equipment, loose furniture, professional fees, and pre-opening operating costs are outside this total. The full development budget remains to be established.

ASSUMPTIONS

Second-generation restaurant space

No structural expansion assumed

Existing capacity and concealed conditions unverified

All figures are invented to test information design. They are not market guidance, a Freeman estimate, or a quotation. Amounts are rounded. The issued estimate will state its drawing revision, pricing date, validity period, tax treatment, fee basis, and treatment of changes; none is established here.

CONSTRUCTION PLANNING TOTAL / ILLUSTRATIVE

$1,500,000

Includes a $150,000 owner-held contingency. Illustrative; not priced against drawings, a site survey, or trade proposals.

COMPONENT	AMOUNT
Trade construction excluding allowances Planning placeholder; unquoted	$1,000,000
Finish and fixture allowances Included once; selections unresolved	$150,000
Millwork →	$80,000
Decorative lighting →	$40,000
Finish selections →	$30,000
General conditions, fee, insurance Combined placeholder; split in detailed estimate	$200,000
Proposed construction subtotal Not a contract sum	$1,350,000
Owner-held construction contingency Separate reserve; not contractor revenue	$150,000
Construction planning total Includes owner contingency	$1,500,000

Allowances are excluded from the $1,000,000 trade line to prevent double counting. Each is an illustrative installed package; labor, freight, taxes, and markups are reconciled in the issued estimate.

OUTSIDE THIS TOTAL

Owner-purchased kitchen equipment and furniture

Architect and consultant fees

Statutory permit and utility connection charges

Leasing, financing, and pre-opening expenses

Hazardous-material remediation and major off-site works

Construction coordination of excluded items can still be included: the purchase is excluded; utility connections and installation coordination may be priced.

NEXT PRICING STEP

Price a detailed estimate against the architect’s drawings once the equipment boundary and existing services are resolved.

See Equipment boundary, Services investigation

MILLWORK ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

ALLOWANCE / WITHIN FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Millwork allowance

$80,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

Bar die and back bar

Host stand

Banquette bases, if built in

Open-kitchen counter front

BASIS

Illustrative installed package for an 80-seat room. No drawings, shop drawings, or fabricator quotation.

Unresolved selection

Bar length and top material; whether the banquette is millwork or loose furniture.

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect; project manager prices

Decision date

Selections approved before week 5, when long-lead orders are released

See Week 4, brief and basis agreed

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Decorative lighting / Finish selections

DECORATIVE LIGHTING ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

ALLOWANCE / WITHIN FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Decorative lighting allowance

$40,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

Pendants over the bar and banquette

Wall sconces

Dimming for decorative circuits

BASIS

Illustrative fixture-and-install package. Fixture selections and quantities not received.

Unresolved selection

Fixture selections, counts, and lead times; dimming control approach.

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect or lighting designer

Decision date

Selections approved before week 5, when long-lead orders are released

See Week 4, brief and basis agreed

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Millwork / Finish selections

FINISH SELECTIONS ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

ALLOWANCE / WITHIN FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Finish selections allowance

$30,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

Feature tile at the open-kitchen wall

Dining room wall finish

Flooring transition at the kitchen threshold

BASIS

Illustrative premium over base finishes carried in the trade line.

Unresolved selection

Tile, wall, and floor selections; cleanability at the kitchen threshold.

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect

Decision date

Selections approved before the week 14 rough-in review

See Week 14, rough-in review

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Millwork / Decorative lighting

06 DECISIONS

The next step is a working session.

We propose reviewing the kitchen responsibility boundary, the existing building services, and a defined preconstruction scope. Freeman would return with a written scope, fee, and deliverable schedule for review.

Construction authorization would follow a separate agreement. Reading or acknowledging this proposal does not authorize work.

THREE OPEN DECISIONS

1 Confirm kitchen equipment purchasing and installation boundary

See Responsibility boundary, Millwork allowance, Week 21, equipment readiness

WHO, AND BY WHEN	Founder, with PM recommendation Before scope pricing
WHY IT MATTERS	Prevents omissions and double pricing

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2 Authorize existing-services and exhaust investigation

See Utility capacity, Exhaust route, Week 8, start gate

WHO, AND BY WHEN	Founder, with architect’s input Before construction baseline
WHY IT MATTERS	Tests schedule and cost assumptions

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3 Confirm preconstruction deliverables and fee

See General conditions and fee, Week 4, basis agreed

WHO, AND BY WHEN	Founder, with Freeman principal Before services begin
WHY IT MATTERS	Establishes the next engagement

Request a working session →

Opens a draft in your email application. Nothing is sent until you send it. To gabe@freemangc.com.

Download this issue ↓

Issue 01, 14 October 2026, with every disclosure and caption.

Prepared by Author to be confirmed / Issue 01 / 14 October 2026

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Built for generations
